

Orkan Selcuk

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EDUCATION

Private Bestepe Anatolian High School – Ankara, Turkey

Anticipated Graduation Date: June 2026

- A-Level Subjects:
 - Mathematics (9709)—A Level Score: A
 - Physics (9702)—A Level Score: A
 - Chemistry (9701)—A Level Score: B
- Current GPA: 4.0

STANDARDIZED TEST SCORES

- SAT: 1410 (*superscore*)
- IELTS: 7.5

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

High School Rocketry – Founder & Captain

Year(s) of involvement: August 2024 – Present

- Ever since I was little, I've been curious about the sky. Throughout the years I feed this passion and curiosity. I always read and learned about aerospace and astronomy. After 3 years of working and gaining technical skills in numerous projects & teams, I've decided to start a model rocketry club in my high school, which is an innovation for where I study. At first, I worked out the basics and the route. Then the team was formed. As of today, we experienced a tough and stressful TEKNOFEST period and are working hard for the Latin American Space Challenge (LASC) 2025.

First Robotics Competition – Mechanic

Year(s) of involvement: March 2022–November 2024

- The First Robotics Competition is a robotics competition held by FIRST. In each year, a new game is being announced, and in a 3-month period, teams build their robots to compete. For almost 3 years, I worked as a mechanic in my school's FRC team, the Chaotics, and enhanced engineering skills through hands-on design and competition. I developed my engineering skills, such as problem-solving, 3D modeling, and object-oriented coding. Within the process, we won 2 awards in 2023, Bosphorus and 2024 Bosphorus Regionals. These awards are the Team Sustainability and Gracious Professionalism awards, respectively.

Shell Eco-Marathon – Aerodynamicist

Year(s) of involvement: December 2023 – March 2024

- Shell Eco-marathon is an international electric-powered car competition in which both university and high school students compete. I participated in Team BEP, the school's electric-powered car team, and designed the thrust system by developing skills such as aerodynamics, mechanical physics, and electronics. We made it through the 2nd period, which is the general inspection, and we couldn't complete the build due to financial constraints. After elimination, we tried to compete in Teknofest 2024. Unfortunately, we could not make it through finals.

Duke of Edinburgh International Award – Bronze Medalist

Year(s) of involvement: February 2022 – September 2024

- Duke of Edinburgh is an international award program in order to support young people to find their purpose, passion, and place in the world. You develop new skills, for instance, hiking, storytelling, playing violin, etc., to complete the program. I learned to play piano, to feed the street animals consistently, and improved my basketball skills by training an extra hour per week. At the end of the program, I and my team, Golden Compass, participated in an “adventurous journey” and walked 20 km, camped, and cooked in 2 successive days. In conclusion, our efforts are awarded with a Bronze Award.

NASA Space Apps Challenge 2024 – Team Leader

Year of involvement: 2024

- NASA Space Apps Challenge is a hackathon that aims to build apps, develop tools, and solve problems of space. In this hackathon, you compete for 36 hrs to address a solution to a chosen challenge. With the experience of the past 3 years, I organized a team to develop a game to demonstrate the ways of exploring exoplanets. We introduced Exoplanet Hunters in beta version. By this innovative learning game, we took our solution to global qualification. Which means the top 900 solutions among 200,000+ participants. I worked as a UI/UX designer and helped to design the front-end algorithm of the game.

HBEC / High School BEST Engineering Competition – Participant/Team Leader

Year(s) of involvement: 2017–2025

- To feed my hunger for engineering and to compete with my peers, I've participated in HBEC in both 2024 and 2025. Solving crises, processing analysis, and co-working are the essential skills for this competition; in two separate years we've managed to make it to 2nd place in school. Being the 2nd does help to take lessons from the outcome. So it was a fulfilling experience.

BESTMUN'24 – IT Specialist

Year(s) of involvement: 2017–2025

- BESTMUN'24 is the Model United Nations of Bestepe College. It is a club that organizes conferences every year. In 2024, I participated as an IT member and played an active role in designing posters, placards, and social media posts, setting the computational systems for conferences. By doing these, I fed my skills in Photoshop and Office programs.

Professional Basketball Player – Player, Guard

Year(s) of involvement: 2017–2025

- Back in the day my father took me to a basketball club (Fenerbahce), and that was the day that I found my eternal passion. In 2015, I started practicing as an 8-year-old, and today I still play at least once a month. From 2017 to 2025 I participated in various teams and roles. I began my career with Ankara Altyapi and ended with Cayyolu Sports A. During this process I also played in my high school's team and won 2 medals, gold and bronze. I was the captain of the team when we won the bronze medal.

eTwinning Project – Designer

Year(s) of involvement: October 2021 – March 2022

- As a preparatory student, I and my team decided to participate in the eTwinning project, which aims to collaborate internationally to present possible solutions for water pollution & poverty. I, personally, helped to design slogans, charts, and videos (introductory). At the end of the period, we took our certificate.

Eskisehir Half-Marathon 2025 – Runner

Year of involvement: August 2025

- Sports have always been an irreplaceable activity in my lifetime. After leaving the courts, I had to find something to deal with. That's when I found out about running. I started to run and then set a goal. I was going to run a 10K race within 2 months. I trained for the whole of June and July. On the 3rd of August, I ran my first race and, with the help of the training, finished 209th among 2000 participants.

Personal Project (AVDS) – Project Leader

- I admire people that make small changes and smooth out their lives. From that perspective, I've asked myself what to do. I do not like shaking while on the road; it really disturbs me. I realized that I can lay the foundation of a project that damps the vibrations for a moving object. I called it the Adaptive Vibration Damping System (AVDS). It's, basically, a smart system that keeps machines from shaking themselves apart—saving energy, reducing noise, and preventing damage. What I've done is only a base and can be adapted and specialized further for more specific objects. You can find the code [here](#).

AWARDS AND HONORS

- Bronze Award – Duke of Edinburgh International Award, 2024
- Certificate of Merit – Ministry of Education, 2024
- Certificate of Honour – Ministry of Education, 2023 and 2024
- Team Sustainability Award – First Robotics Competition, 2023
- Gracious Professionalism Award – First Robotics Competition, 2024
- Bronze Medal – American Mathematics Olympiad (SIMCC), 2024
- Global Sustainability Module – Abdi Ibrahim & Bilim Virusu, 2024
- 3rd Place (*State 3x3 Basketball Championship*) – Turkish Basketball Federation, 2025
- 1st Place (*County Basketball Championship*) – Turkish Basketball Federation, 2022
- HBEC (High School Best Engineering Competition), 2024 and 2025
- Global Nominee – NASA Space Apps Challenge (ranked *in top 1,000 teams out of 200,000 globally*). *Performed the UI/UX design and front-end development.*

SKILLS

- Technical Skills:
 - CAD & Simulation: Fusion360, SOLIDWORKS, Open Rocket
 - Programming: Java, Python (Astrophysical Simulations, basic ML)
 - Creative Tools: Photoshop, Premiere, Illustrator, Office
- Languages:
 - English: Full Professional Proficiency
 - Turkish: Native

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

LOSEV – Volunteer

Year(s) of involvement: June 2024 – Present

- LOSEV is a foundation to treat children with leukemia. Raising funds, organizing festivals, and preparing supply kits are the works I've done by today; however, I would like to volunteer more in order not to lose the sense of humanity and gratitude.

Bestepe Artletics Mentor– Volunteer

Year(s) of involvement: 2022 and 2023 Summer Time

- Bestepe Artletics is not an art and sport school of ours; it is a great place to spend time with children, help them learn skills, play enjoyable sports, and experience delightful art classes in 2 weeks. I volunteered for 2 summers in a row, just because I also had fun doing those things. Being a mentor of the children is an inexpressible journey.

PERSONAL INTERESTS

- Running, Basketball, Reading, Researching, Freestyle Programming, UAV Designing